Low-stakes practice and feedback

Do students have chances to practise and get feedback?

EQUITY / ASSESSMENT

ONE-PAGE TEACHING GUIDE

WHAT IS IT?

Drafts and formative checkpoints are embedded, not reserved for special consideration

WHY DOES IT MATTER?

The same course requirement can land very differently depending on time, money, care, disability, work, housing or confidence. Equity asks whether students with different lives have a real opportunity to participate and succeed, rather than simply receiving the same rule.

THE STUDENT EXPERIENCE

- “This course assumes university is the only thing happening in my life.”
- “I can technically enrol, but the way this is organised makes participation fragile.”

HOW CAN I DO IT?

- Add low-stakes checkpoints that make progress visible before the final due date.
- Use them to surface confusion while there is still time to recover.
- Keep the checkpoint useful even for students who are behind.

EXAMPLE IN PRACTICE

A major essay includes a brief plan submission and feedback checkpoint that all students complete in week 5.

STARTING POINT TO ADAPT

For this assessment, we aim to give students low-stakes opportunities to practise and receive feedback before high-stakes assessment. The learning outcomes being assessed are [insert outcomes].

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Designing assessment

Feedback for learning